1 consequence, therefore, of the conquest of India by the British arms would be, in place of raising, to debase a whole people.

I There is perhaps no example of any conquest in which the natives have been so completely excluded from all share of the government | of their country as in British India.'

Munro was pleading for the employment of Indians in the administration. A year later he wrote again: 'Foreign conquerors have treated the natives with violence, and often with great cruelty, but none has treated them with so much scorn I as we; none has stigmatized the whole people as unworthy of trust, as incapable of honesty, and as fit to be employed only **j** where we cannot do without them. It seems to be not only ungenerous, but impolitic, to debase the character of a people I fallen under our dominion.'*

British dominion was extended to the Punjab by 1850 after two Sikh wars. Maharaja Ranjit Singh, who had held and I extended the Sikh state in the Punjab, had died in 1839. In 1856 Oudh was annexed. Oudh had been virtually under British rule l for half a century, for it was a vassal state, its nominal ruler being both helpless and degenerate, and the British Resident all-powerful.